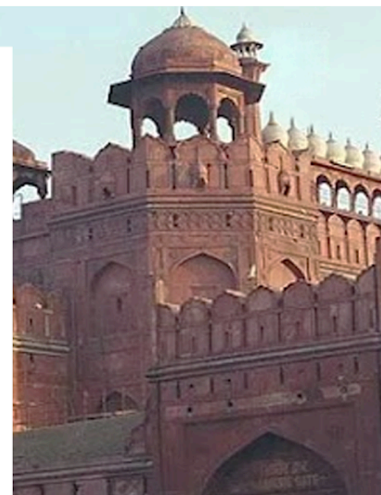
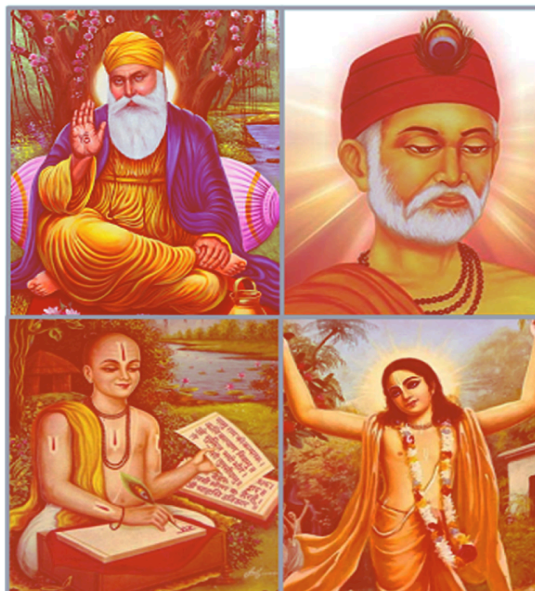
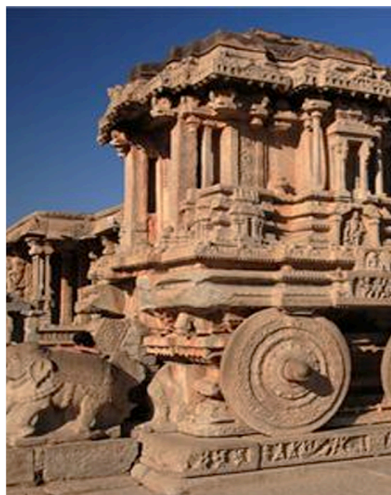


General Knowledge

Medieval History

STUDY NOTES

Jahangir



Jahangir (1569-1627 AD)



Birth and Early Life:

- Jahangir was born to Mariam-uz Zamani and Akbar on 30 August 1569 AD.
- After a long and patient wait and with the blessings of the Sufi saint Mohammad Salim Chishti, Akbar had his first son.
- Jahangir's original name was **Mirza Nur-ud-din Beig Mohammad Khan Salim** which was known simply as **Prince Salim**. He assumed the royal title of
- Jahangir (conqueror of the world) when he assumed the Mughal throne.
- Akbar died in 1605 AD. Jahangir was the eldest and the only surviving son of Akbar who ascended the Mughal throne after his death.

Accession to the Throne:

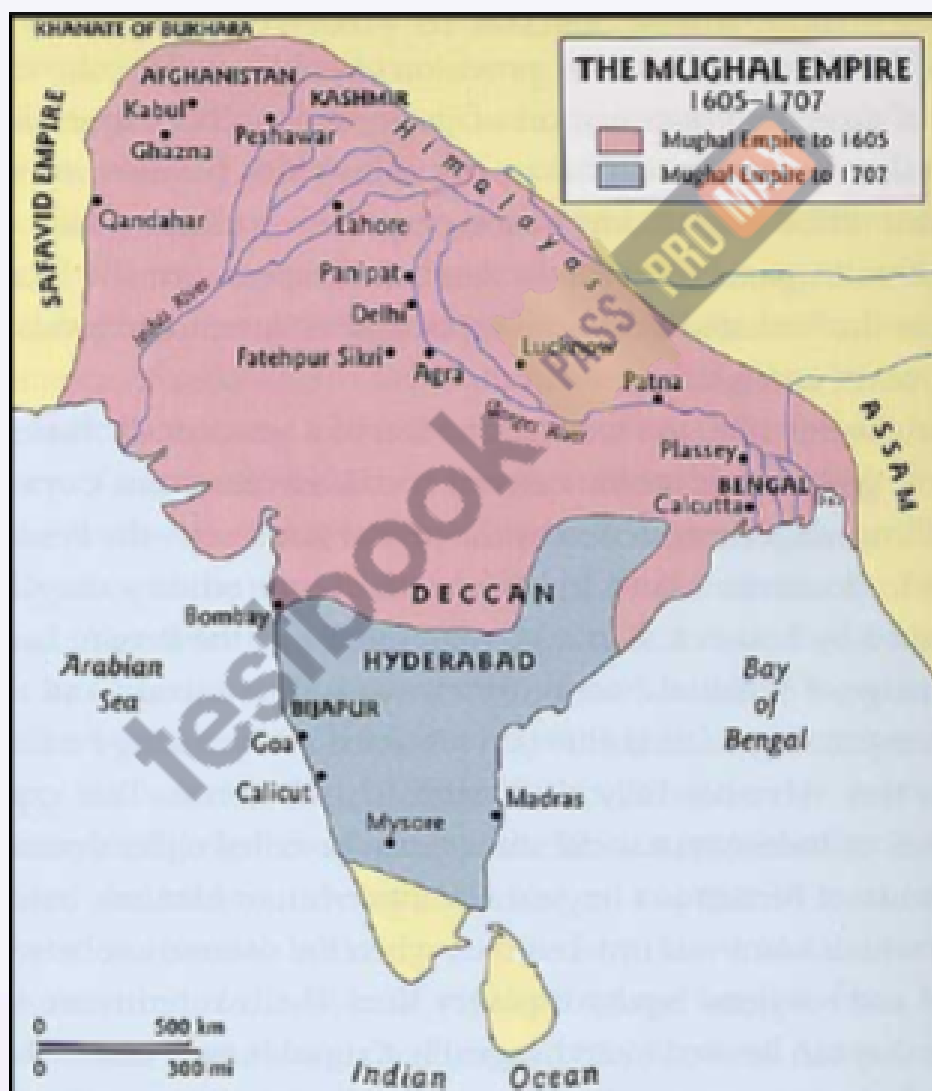
- Jahangir succeeded his father, Akbar, in 1605 AD.
- He defeated a rebellion led by his own son, Khusrau Mirza, and secured his reign.

Military Campaigns:

- **Battle of Dewair (1606 AD):** Fought between Jahangir and Amar Singh-I of Mewar, resulting in Mewar defending its territory.
- **Battle of Assam (1613 AD):** A failed attempt to conquer the Ahom kingdom.
- **Battle of Kangra (1615 AD):** Jahangir's forces, led by Prince Khurram (Shah Jahan), won a decisive victory.

- **Battle of Qandahar (1622 AD):** A major loss for Jahangir, as he lost the vital trade hub of Qandahar to the Persians.
- **Battles in Deccan:** Battle of Ahmadnagar-I (1616 AD): Jahangir's forces, led by Khurram, captured the fort of Ahmednagar.
 - Battle of Ahmadnagar-II (1620 AD): Malik Ambar of Ahmednagar rebelled but was again defeated by the Mughals.

Mughal Political Territory during Jahangir rule (1605-1627 AD):



Relations with Foreign Powers:

- **Portuguese Conflict (1613 AD):** Jahangir retaliated against Portuguese seizures of Mughal ships by confiscating Portuguese churches and properties.
- **British East India Company:** Battle of Swally (1612 AD):
 - British forces, under Thomas Best, defeated the Portuguese, gaining favour with the Mughals.
- **Sir Thomas Roe** secured a treaty with Jahangir, granting the British trading rights and establishing the first factory at Surat in 1613 AD.

Administration and Reforms:

Political:

- He was the governor of Avadh and Bengal before ascending the throne. So, he had administrative experience.
- He followed the same political administration as Akbar had set up.
- Eg. Mansabdari system, Diwan-i-Am, Diwan-i-Khas, etc.

Economic:

- He contributed to boosting trade and commerce inside and outside India.
- For this, he allowed the East India Company of the British to set up a factory and promote exports.
- Eg. The main item was the Indian Liquor which was finding space in the foreign markets.
- Historians believe that Jahangir failed to utilize the advantage of the traditional and new trade routes to boost the economy. His weak administration and lack of trade policies were the major hurdles.

Justice System:

- Jahangir was famous for his '**Chain of the Justice System**'.
- He set up a gold chain with bells to be hung between the Shah Burj in the Agra Fort and a post on the road near the bank of Yamuna.
- The system was anybody who felt injustice was happening to them, could ring the bell and approach the emperor without the mediation of any officer or servant for Justice.
- This was basically to curb the exploitation by Mughal officers.

Personal Life and Influence of Nur Jahan:

- Married Mehr-un-Nisa (Nur Jahan) in 1611 AD, who became a powerful political figure.
- Her influence led to the formation of the "**Nur Jahan Junta**", which had significant sway over Jahangir's decisions, causing tensions with his son Shah Jahan.

JUNTA SYSTEM:

- Nur Jahan formed this group along with her father Itmad-ud- daulah and brother Asaf Khan.
- The motive of the Junta was to influence the emperor Jahangir politically.
- This act created a politically influential position of Junta so that without its backing and support no one could advance in their careers.

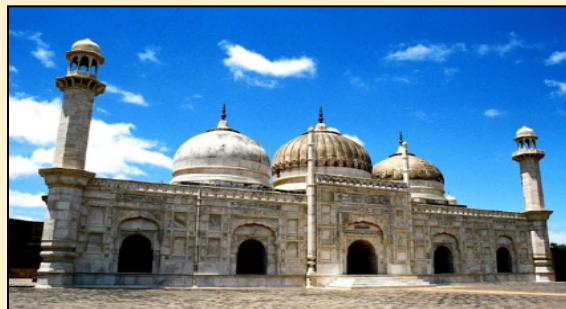
Cultural Contributions:

Patron of art and literature:

Mughal painting flourished, with Indian elements becoming prominent. Miniature art reached new heights.

Architecture:

Jahangir contributed to significant structures, such as:



Shalimar Bagh (Kashmir)	Moti Masjid (Lahore)
 Tomb of Itmad-ud-Daulah	 Akbar's Tomb

Death and Legacy:

- Jahangir's health deteriorated due to alcohol and opium addiction. **He died on October 28, 1627 AD**, during a journey from Kashmir to Lahore.
- He was succeeded by his son Shah Jahan.
- Jahangir is remembered for his contributions to Mughal art, architecture, and diplomacy, despite the setbacks in his military campaigns.